

Course Manager — User Guide

Running an outcome-based course file for accreditation by the Bangladesh Accreditation Council

Version 1.0 · for the single-file application `Course Manager.html` · references the BAC *Accreditation Manual* (2nd ed., 2024), the UGC *Template of OBE Curriculum* (revised) and the BNQF

Course Manager (CM) is a single web page that runs entirely in your browser. It holds one thing well: the course. You write the course learning outcomes, map them to your programme's outcomes, plan delivery and assessment, enter marks, compute attainment, evaluate the offering, and print the documents an accreditation file needs — all from one dataset entered once.

Nothing is installed and nothing is transmitted. Open the file, and it works — on a laptop, offline, in an exam hall. That also means **you** are responsible for keeping the data safe; §3 explains how.

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1 - Who this is for, and what it produces

CM is for the **course teacher**. A programme coordinator or head of department can use it to review what teachers produce, and an IQAC can use its output as course-level evidence, but everything in it is entered by the person teaching the course.

The documents it prints

Six are the key documents of OBE implementation, prepared every semester as the course runs:

DOCUMENT	WHEN	SERVES
Course Outline — UGC format, Parts A–D	Before the semester; given to students	UGC template; BAC 4.8, 5.4
Course Specifications	Before the semester; to the programme coordinator	BAC 4.8, 5.2, 5.8, 10.3

DOCUMENT	WHEN	SERVES
Final Exam Vetting Form	Before the final examination	BAC 5.6
Direct CLO–PLO Calculations	After marking	BAC 4.8 (iv)
Course Evaluation Survey	Last week of teaching	BAC 10.2
Course Report	End of semester; to the programme coordinator	BAC 4.8 (iv), 10.2, 10.3

Five more are course-file records BAC asks for: the CLO–TLA–assessment alignment record, the attendance and make-up record, the timely-feedback record, the teacher's statement, and the course-file checklist.

What it deliberately does not do

CM does not aggregate PLOs across courses, review curricula, or track faculty, facilities and research. Those are programme- and institution-level matters that belong to the Self-Assessment Report and the IQAC. Nor does it carry the engineering-specific machinery of BAETE accreditation (the fixed twelve programme outcomes, WK/WP/EA attributes, complex-problem claims); BAC's criteria are general across disciplines.

2 • First run: Setup

Do this **once**, before the first course. Open the **Setup** section.

- 1 Institution and programme offering entity.** Institution name, address, faculty, department/POE, the default programme, the degree level and the BNQF level. These print on every document header.
- 2 Logo.** Upload once; it is stored inside your data (resized automatically) and prints on every document in grayscale.
- 3 Signatory titles.** Who signs: head of department, programme coordinator, chair of the moderation committee, IQAC director. Change the wording to your institution's own titles — the documents use whatever you type.
- 4 Programme Learning Outcomes.** Enter your programme's own PLOs — any number of them. Give each a code (the matrix column heading) and the BNQF learning-outcome domain it mainly belongs to. Sample PLOs are supplied so you can see the shape; replace them with your approved list.
- 5 Default thresholds.** The pass mark, the cohort target and the direct/indirect weighting that every new course inherits (§6).

- 6 Letter-grade scale.** Your institution's scale. CM reads the numerical ranges you type to compute the grade distribution, so keep the wording in the pattern shown (65% to less than 70% , 80% and above , Below 40%).

THE FOUR BNQF DOMAINS

Fundamental — discipline knowledge and application of skills. **Social** — working with people, communication, community engagement. **Thinking** — learning to learn, decision-making, problem solving, critical thinking, entrepreneurship. **Personal** — life-long learning, self-direction, integrity, citizenship, time management, teamwork.

A single course need not touch all four. The programme as a whole must.

3 - Where your data lives

The **File** menu in the header always tells you, and offers three ways to store the same data.

OPTION	WHAT IT MEANS	USE IT WHEN
This browser	Always active. Data persists across reloads in this browser's storage. It is lost if browser data is cleared, and it does not follow you to another computer.	Never rely on it alone
A file on this computer	Work directly on a <code>.json</code> file the way Word works on a <code>.docx</code> ; every change auto-saves to it. Needs Chrome or Edge on a desktop.	One teacher, one machine
Google Drive	The same file kept in your Drive, synced a couple of seconds after each change, reachable from any machine.	Two machines, or a backup you cannot forget

Press **Ctrl+S** (⌘S on a Mac) at any time to flush everything immediately and confirm. Closing the tab with unsaved changes warns you first.

Setting up Google Drive

CM ships with no Google credentials of its own — that is deliberate, since bundled credentials would put every institution's data behind one shared key. Your institution registers its own OAuth client once, and everyone pastes the same Client ID:

- 1** In the Google Cloud Console, create (or choose) a project and **enable the Google Drive API**.
- 2** Go to **APIs & Services** ▸ **Credentials** ▸ **Create credentials** ▸ **OAuth client ID** and choose type **Web application**.
- 3** Add the address CM is served from as an **Authorized JavaScript origin**. CM tells you the exact value in the setup dialog.

- 4 Copy the Client ID (it ends in `.apps.googleusercontent.com`) and paste it into **File ▶ Set up Google Drive...**
- 5 Then use **File ▶ Save to Google Drive as...** to create the file, or **Open from Google Drive...** to pick up an existing one.

TWO LIMITS WORTH KNOWING

Drive needs CM to be served from a real web address; it cannot authenticate a page opened straight from disk (`file://`). And CM requests only the `drive.file` scope, so it can see nothing in your Drive except files it created or you opened through it — which is also why the Drive file list shows only CM's own files.

If the same file was edited elsewhere

When CM finds that the Drive copy changed after your last sync, the File chip turns red and reads **conflict**, auto-sync stops, and the menu offers exactly two ways out: **Keep mine — overwrite the Drive file**, or **Load the Drive version instead**. CM will not merge the two; decide which is authoritative.

Backups are still your job

Data & Backup ▶ Export all data (JSON) writes one file containing every course, your Setup and the logo. Export at the end of every semester and after every marks session, and keep the JSON with the course file. It is also the form a department needs if course data is consolidated for accreditation reporting. **Import backup** replaces everything; **Merge courses from a backup** adds only courses you do not already have — the safer choice when collecting files from colleagues.

4 - The semester at a glance

WHEN	WHAT YOU DO	WHERE IN CM
Once	Institution, PLOs, thresholds, grading scale	Setup
Before teaching	Course identity, objectives, rationale, textbooks, facilities	Course Info
	Act on the previous offering's recommendations	CQI Inputs card in T&L and Assessments
	CLOs, PLO mapping, domains; activities, notional hours, weekly plan; assessment plan and weights	CLOs & Mapping · T&L · Assessments
	Print and hand out the Course Outline ; submit the Course Specifications	Documents
While teaching	Log every session, cancellation and make-up class	Attendance
	Record the date each assessment was held and its results returned	Assessments
	Enter marks as they are earned	Students & Marks
Before the final	Get the paper moderated; record the committee and its observations	Documents ▸ Final Exam Vetting Form
	Run the student survey and enter the response counts	Documents ▸ Survey · Attainment ▸ Student Survey
After results	Read CLO, PLO and combined attainment	Attainment
	Write the evaluation and the action plans for next time	CQI
	Print the Calculations , the Course Report , the records and the checklist	Documents

WHEN	WHAT YOU DO	WHERE IN CM
Next offering	Duplicate the course; the report's actions arrive as your new inputs	Dashboard or CQI

5 - Dashboard

The status board. Six counters (CLOs, how many are mapped, assessment items, students, share of marks entered, CLOs attained), then the workflow list, in which every step shows **done** or **pending** and jumps to its section.

If the course carries recommendations from a previous Course Report that you have not yet responded to, a red-topped card lists them here and the T&L step stays **pending** until each has a recorded response. That is intentional: an unanswered recommendation means the improvement loop is open.

Two buttons live at the bottom of the workflow card: **Duplicate for next offering** (§15) and **Delete this course**. Deletion cannot be undone — export first.

6 - Course Info and the thresholds

Course identity and everything a course plan must state under BAC Criterion 4.8: pre-requisites, credit value, objectives, synopsis/rationale, textbooks, reading materials, the facilities the CLOs require, the assessment criteria students must know in advance, and your contact and consultation hours. All of it prints on the Course Outline and the Specifications.

Two numbers at the bottom of this section govern every result CM reports. Set them **before** marking, agree them with your department, and leave them alone thereafter.

HOW A CLO IS JUDGED

A **student** attains a CLO when the marks they obtained on the items tagged to that CLO reach the **pass mark** (default 40%) of the marks allocated to it.

The **CLO** is attained when the percentage of assessed students who attained it reaches the **target** (default 50%).

The other two fields split direct and indirect evidence (default 80% marks / 20% survey) and set the survey rating that counts as attainment (default 4 on a 1–5 scale).

Changing a threshold after results are reported silently re-computes every figure you have already circulated. If a value must change, note it in the Course Report so the two versions can be told apart.

7 · CLOs & Mapping

Writing the outcomes

Each CLO is one sentence naming something a student can be seen to do. Choose the Bloom's level and the BNQF domain the outcome mainly develops. The UGC template suggests **3–5 CLOs** per course, and CM tells you when you are outside that range.

CM flags openings that cannot be measured — *know, understand, learn, be aware of, appreciate* — and suggests observable verbs instead. The flag is advice, not a lock; but a CLO you cannot assess will report as unattained however well the class did.

Instead of “Students will understand research ethics.” **Write** “Evaluate the ethical implications of a proposed research design and justify the safeguards chosen.” The second names the performance, the evidence and the level.

The CLO–PLO matrix

Click a cell to cycle the mapping strength: blank → **1** low → **2** medium → **3** high. Hover a PLO code to read its statement. The bottom row counts how many CLOs address each PLO.

Map honestly. A CLO mapped to nothing contributes nothing at programme level; a CLO mapped to everything “to be safe” dilutes the programme picture and is the first thing a reviewer questions. The domain-coverage panel below the matrix shows which BNQF domains your CLOs actually develop.

8 · T&L: activities, hours, weekly plan

Three cards, and at the top of the section the **CQI Inputs from the Previous Offering** card (§13).

Activities per CLO

Tick the teaching-learning activities that will develop each CLO — hover any of them for a practical classroom tip — or type your own in the “other activity” field. Every CLO needs at least one: the alignment record and the teacher's statement both depend on it.

Notional hours (student learning time)

For each CLO, the hours an average student spends: lecture/contact, tutorial, laboratory, independent study, and assessment preparation. CM totals them and compares the total against a guide of about **40 notional hours per credit**, flagging a gap over 15%. If your institution uses a different figure, treat the guide as advisory and record your own basis in the Specifications.

Weekly plan

Topics week by week, the CLOs each week serves, the activity and the contact hours. The footer row shows how many weeks touch each CLO — a CLO with no week is a planning error, not a rounding one. This table feeds Part B of the Course Outline and §4.1 of the Specifications, and the assessment column of the Outline is typed on the document itself.

9 - Assessments

An assessment is a quiz, assignment, mid-term, final, project, presentation, and so on. Inside it, each **item** is the thing that actually measures a CLO: a question, a task, a rubric row.

FIELD	WHY IT MATTERS
Weight %	Should total 100% across all assessments; CM shows the running total.
Date held / Feedback given on	Criterion 5.5 wants results returned in time. CM shows the gap and flags anything beyond two weeks.
Rubric shared in advance	Criterion 5.4. Tick it only when the rubric exists and students have seen it.
Item ▶ CLO	The tag that turns a mark into evidence. An untagged item's marks count in the class total but reach no CLO.
Item ▶ Bloom level	Feeds the higher-order-thinking share (Criterion 5.1) and the vetting form.
Item ▶ Max marks	The denominator when CM judges that CLO.

The lower card shows how the marks are distributed across CLOs and the percentage of marks sitting at Analyze, Evaluate or Create. A CLO carrying no marks is reported in red — Criterion 5.2(v) has you certify that all CLOs were assessed.

10 - Students & Marks

Add students one at a time, or paste a list from a spreadsheet — one per line, ID then name, separated by a tab, comma or semicolon. Duplicated IDs are skipped.

The marks grid has one column per item, with sticky headers and a frozen ID/name column. Marks save as you type and are capped at each item's maximum. For bulk work, use **Empty CSV template** (CM writes the exact headers it will accept back), fill it in Excel, then **Import CSV**; unknown IDs are added as new students. **Export marks CSV** gives you the filled sheet.

A blank cell means “not assessed”, not zero: a student with no marks at all against a CLO is excluded from that CLO's calculation rather than counted as failing it. Partial data therefore looks like a smaller cohort, not like poor performance — check that every column is filled before reading Attainment.

11 • Attendance

One row per session: date, kind (lecture, tutorial, lab, other), topic, how many were present, whether it was cancelled, whether it was a make-up class, and a note for the reason or the notice issued. Four counters summarise sessions held, missed, made up, and average attendance.

Record the approved class-routine reference at the top; Criterion 5.3 expects the routine, the attendance record and the make-up record together. A head-count per session is enough for the printed summary — the signed attendance sheets stay in the physical file. The second card restates the feedback dates from the assessment plan as the Criterion 5.5 record.

12 - Attainment

Four views, chosen with the sub-tabs.

CLO — Direct

Computed from marks. For each CLO: marks allocated, students assessed, students attaining, the percentage attaining, the class average, and the verdict against the target. The chart draws the target as a dashed line; bars that fall short are red.

PLO Contribution

Each PLO's value is the mapping-weighted average of the direct attainment of the CLOs mapped to it, so a strength-3 mapping counts three times a strength-1. A single course only *contributes* to a PLO — programme-level PLO attainment aggregates many courses, which CM does not attempt.

Student Survey (Indirect)

Enter the number of respondents and, for each CLO, how many chose each rating from 1 to 5. Block B captures general course feedback (means are computed for you) and Block C is where you summarise the open-ended answers. The blank instrument prints from Documents ► Course Evaluation Survey.

Combined

Direct and survey results weighted by the split you set in Course Info (80/20 by default). A CLO with no survey data shows its direct value unchanged rather than being penalised.

Student ratings are good evidence about experience and workload and weak evidence about learning. That is exactly why they are weighted at 20% rather than averaged in — and why the Course Report asks you to comment on them rather than simply report them.

13 - CQI: closing the loop

CM runs **one** improvement loop, carried by two linked tables:

THE LOOP

Previous **Course Report 6.1** → this offering's **Course Specifications 6.1** (what we are doing about it) → teach, assess, measure → this offering's **Course Report 6.1** (what the next one should do) → duplicate → and round again.

Both tables are one shared dataset with four rows: the CLO loop and the PLO loop, each by direct measurement and by survey. Edit them in the CQI section, in the printed documents, or in the CQI Inputs card — all three write to the same place.

The CQI section, top to bottom

- 1 Recommendations from the previous Course Report.** Arrives filled when the course was duplicated. The right-hand column records what this offering's plan actually does about each one.
- 2 What the evidence says.** CLOs attained, CLOs below target by marks and by survey, PLOs below target — read automatically from your data.
- 3 Course evaluation by the teacher.** What went well, difficulties faced, and the four comment fields that print in the Course Report.
- 4 Suggested action plans for the next offering.** One cell per loop. **Draft from the evidence** seeds a line for every CLO and PLO below target, naming the number that triggered it; you complete the action.

Where the recommendations are actually used

Storing them is not using them. So the previous offering's recommendations also appear in a **CQI Inputs from the Previous Offering** card at the top of **T&L** and **Assessments** — the two sections where you revise the course — each with a “Reflected in this offering” cell to fill in. The card also lists any activity you judged ineffective last time, so it is reconsidered rather than re-adopted out of habit. Until every recommendation has a response, the Dashboard flags it and the T&L step stays pending.

↑ **Pull from this course's Course Report 6.1** copies this course's own report cells into the empty recommendation cells — useful when you write the report before opening the next offering.

A good action names four things: the CLO or PLO, the number that triggered it, what changes in teaching, assessment or student preparation, and when. “CLO2 attained by 41% against a 50% target — add two tutorials of worked analytical examples before the mid-term, next offering.” A recommendation that cannot be checked next time is not an action.

14 • Documents

Every document is a live view of the data you have already entered. Fields with a dotted underline are typed on the document itself and save immediately; everything else comes from the other sections. Two buttons at the top: **Print / Save as PDF** (the browser's dialog — choose “Save as PDF”) and **Export for Word (.doc)** if a document has to be edited further or merged into a departmental template.

DOCUMENT	WHAT YOU FILL IN ON IT
Course Outline	Year/level, contact hours and total marks (both pre-filled from your data, typed only to override), marks-distribution percentages, the assessment and co-curricular columns of the weekly plan, the assessment strategy, make-up procedures, supplementary readings and “others”, and the prepared/checked/approved block.
Course Specifications	Date of submission, final-examination hours, §6.1 recommendations and responses, §6.2 other modifications.
Final Exam Vetting Form	Moderation date, internal and external members, the committee's observations. The question analysis, CLO coverage, Bloom distribution and higher-order share are computed. The checklist is printed for the committee to tick on paper.
Direct CLO–PLO Calculations	Nothing — it is entirely computed, and states its own method.
Course Evaluation Survey	Nothing — the blank instrument to hand out or post.
Course Report	CLO modifications (§2.1), actual hours and reasons for variation over 25% (§3.1), activity effectiveness (§3.2), resource adequacy (§3.3), the comment fields, §6.1 action plans, and the head of department's comments.
The five records	Alignment, attendance and make-up, feedback, the teacher's statement (with a warning if any CLO still lacks an activity or an assessment), and the course-file checklist.

15 • Starting the next offering

Duplicate for next offering, on the Dashboard or in the CQI section, is how a course moves forward. Do not use it to “clear” the current offering — the current one is your record.

CARRIED OVER	CLEARED
CLOs, PLO mapping and domains; activities and notional hours; the weekly plan; the assessment plan; textbooks, facilities, thresholds and Setup. Course Report 6.1 becomes the new Course Specifications 6.1 , and activities you judged ineffective are carried as a caution.	Students and marks; attendance; survey responses; moderation; the teacher's statement; the report's comment fields; actual hours; assessment dates and feedback dates; the file checklist.

Then set the new semester in Course Info, and start in the CQI Inputs card.

16 • Worked example: the arithmetic

Load the demonstration course (Dashboard or Data & Backup) to see all of this with real numbers. Here is the shape of it for one outcome.

Suppose CLO2 is measured by three items — an assignment task worth 15, a mid-term question worth 10 and a final question worth 12 — so **37 marks are allocated to CLO2**. The pass mark is 40% and the target 50%. Eighteen students were assessed.

STEP	CALCULATION
One student's CLO2 score	A student scoring $6 + 4 + 5 = 15$ of 37 $\rightarrow 40.5\% \rightarrow$ at or above the 40% pass mark $\rightarrow$ attained
Direct CLO attainment	If 8 of the 18 assessed students reach 40% $\rightarrow 8 \div 18 = 44.4\% \rightarrow$ below the 50% target $\rightarrow$ not attained
Survey (indirect)	Of 18 respondents, 11 rated CLO2 at 4 or 5 $\rightarrow 11 \div 18 = 61.1\%$
Combined (80 / 20)	$(0.80 \times 44.4) + (0.20 \times 61.1) = 35.5 + 12.2 = 47.7\% \rightarrow$ still below target
Contribution to a PLO	If PLO2 is served by CLO2 at strength 3 (44.4%) and CLO4 at strength 1 (72%): $(3 \times 44.4 + 1 \times 72) \div 4 = 51.3\%$
Grade distribution	Each student's total marks $\div$ total marks allocated, placed in your Setup scale — independent of the CLO calculation

Two properties follow from this and are worth internalising. Attainment is a **headcount**, not a class average: a cohort can average well and still miss the target if the marks are concentrated in a few students. And the pass mark is applied **per CLO**, not to the course total, so a student can pass the course while failing an outcome — which is precisely what makes CLO-level reporting useful.

17 • Assembling the course file

Documents ▶ Course File Checklist is the packing list, in two tables. Table A is the UGC *Template for Course File* — twelve items, including peer review as Done / Not done — with each row naming where CM produces it, a tick box, and a remarks field. A row marked “ready” means the content is already complete inside CM and only needs printing. Table B adds the evidence BAC Standards 5 and 10 expect beyond the UGC list: the Specifications, the alignment record, the signed routine, make-up notices, tutorial records, the feedback record, the vetting form, the lab log book, the marks sheet and the teacher's statement.

Some items CM cannot produce, and does not pretend to: lecture materials, sample scripts at high, medium and low performance, question papers themselves, and signed attendance sheets. Those you file by hand.

18 · Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	CAUSE AND REMEDY
A CLO reports 0%, but the class did well	No item is tagged to it, or no marks are entered for those items. Check the marks-distribution card in Assessments.
Attainment looks unexpectedly high or low	The pass mark or target in Course Info is not what you assumed, or marks are only partly entered. Check both before reporting.
A PLO shows “not mapped”	No CLO maps to it in this course. That is normal — one course cannot serve every PLO.
Weights do not total 100%	The Assessment Plan header shows the running total; adjust the weights, or use “Prefill from Assessments” on the Outline to keep the two consistent.
The grade distribution shows dashes	Your Setup grade rows do not carry readable numeric ranges. Follow the pattern <code>65% to less than 70%</code> .
“Save to Google Drive” does nothing	No Client ID (File ► Set up Google Drive...), the page is opened from disk rather than a web address, or this page's origin is not an authorized JavaScript origin on the OAuth client.
The File chip says “conflict”	The Drive copy changed elsewhere. Choose “Keep mine” or “Load the Drive version”; auto-sync resumes afterwards.
The chip says “reconnect”	Browsers drop file permission between sessions. Click it and grant access; CM then offers to load the file's data or keep the browser's.
No file options at all	Firefox, Safari and mobile browsers cannot write directly to a file. Use Chrome or Edge on a desktop, or use Drive, or export JSON regularly.
Everything disappeared	Browser data was cleared, or you are in a different browser or profile. Import your last JSON backup. This is the failure that backups exist for.
Printing spills awkwardly	Print one document at a time from Documents; set the browser's scale to “Default” and margins to “Default”, and choose landscape for the widest tables.

19 · Glossary

CLO	Course Learning Outcome — what a student can do on completing this course.
PLO	Programme Learning Outcome — what a graduate of the programme can do. Defined once in Setup.
BNQF domain	One of four learning-outcome domains — Fundamental, Social, Thinking, Personal.

POE	Programme Offering Entity — the department, faculty or institute that owns the programme.
Direct / indirect measure	Direct = marks. Indirect = the student survey. Combined weights the two.
SLT / notional hours	Student learning time: contact plus independent study plus assessment preparation.
HOTS	Higher-order thinking skills — items at Analyze, Evaluate or Create.
CQI	Continuous Quality Improvement — here, the Specifications 6.1 ⇌ Report 6.1 loop.
Constructive alignment	Outcomes, teaching activities and assessment all serving the same intention.
Moderation / vetting	Review of the final paper by a committee including an external member.

20 - Criterion map

CRITERION	REQUIREMENT, IN SHORT	WHERE CM ANSWERS IT
BAC 4.3, 4.4	PLOs within the POE's mission; measurable outcomes	Setup; CLOs & Mapping
BAC 4.6	CLOs aligned with PLOs; rationale for each course	CLO–PLO matrix; Course Info
BAC 4.8	Course file with a course plan; course evaluation report	Course Outline; Specifications; Calculations
BAC 5.1	Assessments promoting higher-order thinking; evidence kept	Assessments; vetting form
BAC 5.2	SLT matching credit; all CLOs delivered and assessed; teacher's certification	T&L; Assessments; teacher's statement
BAC 5.3	Routine, attendance, missed and make-up classes	Attendance
BAC 5.4	Criteria and plan known to students in advance	Course Outline; rubric ticks
BAC 5.5	Timely feedback on continuous assessments	Assessment dates; feedback record
BAC 5.6	Final paper moderated with an external member	Final Exam Vetting Form
BAC 5.8	Alignment of CLOs, activities and assessment	Alignment record; Specifications §3.1
BAC 5.9	Tutorial classes provided	Attendance (session kind)

CRITERION	REQUIREMENT, IN SHORT	WHERE CM ANSWERS IT
BAC 10.2	Teacher's and students' course evaluation	Survey; Course Report §3.4, §5.1
BAC 10.3	Feedback used for improvement	Specifications 6.1 ⇄ Report 6.1; CQI Inputs card
UGC template	Course outline Parts A–D; course-file template	Course Outline; Course File Checklist

FURTHER READING

CM's **About** section carries 35 numbered references — on outcome-based design, writing outcomes, active learning, workload, assessment and feedback, rubrics, student surveys and quality cycles — together with a table explaining what each part of the app rests on. Every section's heading strip cites the relevant numbers; click one to jump to the citation.

Where the literature and a regulation disagree, the regulation governs what must be filed.